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The Security Perspective

The military operations room is the sanctum sanctorum of the Army HQ. It has a state-of-the-art projection system and videoconferencing facility. Crammed with maps and charts which go up and down or slide into and out of the walls, it is manned round the clock. As additional DGMO, I had the privilege of being the leader of the team that managed all discussions and presentations held in this room. Later, as the chief, I presided over the deliberations here and gave directions on issues of operational significance. Presentations, intelligence briefings and review of operational plans were keenly looked forward to by me. We had to be clear about the challenges that our armed forces faced and be prepared for them. A series of briefings were conducted to update me as the chief designate, starting from December 2004. Based on these interactions and my own study and experience, the security scenario as I perceive it has been covered in the following paragraphs.

During the last two decades, the global security environment has witnessed a paradigm shift. With more than one power centre beginning to emerge in the new world order, strategic partnerships and dialogue encompassing the security, socioeconomic and political fields have replaced the stratagem of coercion or containment. The impact of 9/11 has shaken the world. No nation, howsoever powerful, is secure from the scourge of terrorism, which today occupies centre stage in all security equations, thus transcending state boundaries. We are witnessing the birth of fourth-generation warfare, which goes beyond the canvas of conventional military operations. This has resulted in the global war